

Grok 4.6 Levels Up, Lovable's Valuation Doubles, and the Lakers Sell for a Record \$12.5B

TL;DR

- ▶ Grok 4.6 launched at near-frontier intelligence scores while undercutting rivals on price by about 60%.
- ▶ Bob Iger and Josh Kushner are buying the LA Lakers for a record \$12.5B, topping last year's record by 25%.
- ▶ Lovable raised \$400M at a \$13.3B valuation, more than doubling in eight months.

AI TIPS

use AI better — how to do it

Turn Claude Voice into a hands-free morning brief

1. Connect the tools you trust to Claude Voice — Gmail, Google Calendar, Google Docs, Slack.
2. Ask for your calendar first, then have it summarize email/Slack items tied to those meetings — split it into steps rather than asking for everything at once.
3. Have it close with priorities and a flag for anything that needs your approval before it acts.

Paste-ready: Check today's calendar first. Then summarize urgent email and Slack items tied to those meetings. Finish with three priorities and flag anything that needs my approval before action.

Source: The Neuron

Give AI the messy first draft, not just the final polish

1. Identify where a task actually starts — research, testing, cutting, rearranging — not the finished output.
2. Hand AI the earlier, messier stages where it's most useful and most steerable, instead of only the last-mile polish.
3. Tell it upfront what format you work in (Word doc, spreadsheet, deck) so the output lands in a usable shape.
4. If you can't judge the result at a glance, don't ship it without review.

Source: The Rundown AI

Turn a PRD into a working app without an engineer

1. Write a product requirements document for what you want built, using Claude.
2. Hand the PRD to Lovable to generate a first working version.
3. Have it integrate your real data sources (calendar, tasks, files) so the tool reflects actual use, not a demo.
4. Ship it as a simple password-protected site instead of paying for an off-the-shelf tool.

Source: The Rundown AI

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

SpaceXAI released Grok 4.6, scoring 61 on Artificial Analysis' Intelligence Index — just behind Opus 5 (63) and Fable 5 (62), and ahead of GPT-5.6 Sol — while pricing at \$2/\$6 per million tokens, roughly 60% below rival frontier models. Musk says Grok 4.7 is "3 to 4 weeks" out and will "exceed all current models."

What it means for you: Frontier pricing keeps compressing. Worth re-checking any client cost models built around Opus/GPT pricing now that a credible near-frontier option undercuts them by more than half.

Source: The Neuron, The Rundown AI

AI app-builder Lovable raised \$400M at a \$13.3B valuation, more than doubling its valuation since a December raise.

What it means for you: A signal of how fast the "AI builds your app" category is scaling — worth tracking as a build-vs-buy option for smaller client tools.

Source: The Neuron, The Rundown AI

Anthropic turned Claude's Chrome side panel into a full "Cowork" session, syncing history, Skills, connectors, and multi-step tasks across Chrome and Claude's apps.

What it means for you: Directly usable in your own workflow — worth trialing if you're already running Claude across browser and desktop.

Source: The Neuron

Google's Gemini app passed 1 billion users, its fastest-growing product ever, the same week it launched the Pixel 11 with deeper Gemini voice and task features at \$100 more than the prior generation.

What it means for you: Google is bundling AI distribution with hardware pricing power — a template worth watching if you're advising clients on AI-as-upsell strategy.

Source: The Rundown AI, 1440 Daily Digest, Morning Brew

Sources: **The Neuron**, **The Rundown AI**, **Morning Brew**, **1440 Daily Digest** (Aug 13). Newsletter links are click-tracked, so titles are cited rather than raw URLs. **impactmakers** · AI Brief

Bob Iger and Josh Kushner are buying a controlling stake in the LA Lakers for a record \$12.5B, topping the \$10B record set just a year ago when Mark Walter bought the team from the Buss family. Walter — under federal investigation over alleged loan-related tax fraud — is reportedly selling in part to raise cash.

PM angle: Sports franchise valuations are a live case study in how fast asset prices are inflating on media-rights growth — a useful reference point in any client conversation about valuation multiples running ahead of fundamentals.

Conversation starter: *Sports team valuations jumped 25% in about a year — makes you wonder how much of that is media rights and how much is just momentum.*

Source: Morning Brew, 1440 Daily Digest

July inflation data came in tame: the annual rate cooled to 3.4% from 3.5% in June, with core inflation at its lowest since 2021. (1440 and Morning Brew disagree on the month-over-month move — 1440 reports CPI *fell* 0.1% in July, Morning Brew reports it *rose* 0.1% — but both agree on the 3.4% annual figure.)

PM angle: A second straight tame inflation reading gives more room to hold pricing and budget assumptions steady into Q4 planning conversations.

Conversation starter: *Two straight months of cool inflation data — are we still bracing for a Fed hike, or is that off the table for now?*

Source: 1440 Daily Digest, Morning Brew

The US budget deficit hit \$432B in July, the highest monthly level since March 2021, driven largely by rising Medicare costs; the 2026 deficit total stands at \$1.8T so far.

PM angle: Worth flagging for any public-sector or healthcare-adjacent client work — federal spending pressure like this tends to surface eventually as budget scrutiny on contracts and grants.

Conversation starter: *With the deficit at a five-year high, are we expecting any tightening on the government-facing side of the business?*

Source: 1440 Daily Digest, Morning Brew

Wendy's stock jumped nearly 15% on reports that activist investor Nelson Peltz is lining up investors to take the chain private, after six straight quarters of declining same-store sales.

PM angle: A live example of the activist-investor playbook — relevant if you're advising retail or restaurant clients navigating shareholder pressure to restructure.

Conversation starter: *Wendy's stock popped 15% just on take-private rumors — good reminder how much activist chatter alone can move a stock.*

Source: 1440 Daily Digest, Morning Brew

A sponsored Tate McRae skincare ad for Neutrogena drew backlash after viewers noticed she barely touched product to her face — the clip has racked up roughly 19 million views on TikTok, with top comments calling out the staged routine.

PM angle: A sharp reminder that audiences now scrutinize sponsored content for authenticity — worth keeping in mind for any client work involving influencer or testimonial-driven marketing.

Conversation starter: *That Neutrogena ad backlash is a good case study — staged testimonials get called out fast now, even from top creators.*

Source: Morning Brew